■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, October 23, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (6 stories)

■ *Mysterious black triangles spotted going 1,800 mph over secret US military bases, latest UFO file dump reveals*

The Angle: *A fresh UFO document dump claims mystery black triangle craft were buzzing secret US military bases at nearly Mach 2 with zero vapor trail — the kind of story that splits a room into 'cover-up' and 'cope' camps instantly.*

- Objects described as **black triangles** were tracked moving up to **1,800 mph**
- Sightings reportedly occurred over **secret US military bases**
- Witnesses/reports note **no vapor trails**, adding to the mystery of the propulsion
- Details surfaced as part of the **latest UFO file dump**

The Debate Starter

- Black triangle, no trail, 1,800 mph — are we buying secret military tech or something way weirder?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/10/23/us-news/mysterious-black-triangles-spotted-over-secret-us-military-bases-latest-ufo-file-dump-reveals/

■ *A mutated virus is driving the US into an early flu season, especially on the West Coast - CNN*

The Angle: *Flu season usually waits for the holidays — this year it showed up months ahead of schedule thanks to a mutated strain, and the West Coast is getting hit hardest. It's the kind of story that makes people actually go get their shot instead of putting it off.*

- Flu season is ramping up **months ahead of schedule** this year
- A **mutated version of the virus** is behind the early spread
- The surge is hitting **parts of the West Coast** especially hard
- Catching a lot of people off guard — most aren't even thinking about flu shots yet

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have you gotten your flu shot yet, or are you waiting until someone in your house actually gets sick?

CNN (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cnn.com/2026/10/22/health/flu-2026-mutation

■ *Mysterious black triangles spotted going 1,800 mph over secret US military bases, latest UFO file dump reveals https://t.co/5qBfpauwdi https*

The Angle: *A fresh batch of declassified UFO files is naming actual secret US military bases where mystery aircraft allegedly blew past known physics — this is the kind of "is the government hiding something" story that always gets phone lines lit up.*

- Latest **UFO file dump** reportedly details sightings of **black triangle** aircraft near secret US military installations.
- Witnesses/reports describe the objects moving at roughly **1,800 mph**, well beyond typical aircraft speeds.
- Story is circulating via **New York Post**, reigniting the long-running "black triangle UFO" reports that have popped up for decades.

The Believer Test

- Be honest — if the government dropped proof tomorrow, would you actually want to know?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2113602081705664736

■■ *Mass. voter turnout exceeds half a million ahead of 2026 midterm election*

The Angle: *Half a million-plus ballots already in and we're still weeks out from the 2026 midterms - early numbers like this are usually read as a tell for turnout nationwide, so it's worth watching before everyone else is talking about it.*

- **Massachusetts** has already seen more than **half a million** voters turn out ahead of the **2026 midterm election**
- The surge is happening well before Election Day itself, suggesting unusually high early engagement

The Civic Pulse Check

- Does early turnout like this actually predict a big night in November, or are we reading too much into it?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.wcvb.com/article/2026-massachusetts-voter-turnout-early-voting-update-oct-22/74217228

■ *Students at a Georgia elementary school discovered their cafeteria wasted nearly 450 pounds of food a day. Six years later, they had cut waste by 70%, redistributed more than 20,000 food items annually, and were feeding scraps to the school's chickens.*

The Angle: *A feel-good food-waste story with a twist that writes its own punchline: elementary schoolers turned a cafeteria problem into a six-year sustainability win, scraps and all.*

- The cafeteria was tossing nearly **450 pounds of food a day** before the students got involved.
- Over **six years**, the school slashed that waste by **70%**.
- More than **20,000 food items** a year now get redistributed instead of trashed.
- Leftover scraps go straight to feeding the school's own **chickens**.

The Feel-Good Hook

- Call in: what's the most food your kid's school (or your own job) wastes in a day — and would you trust chickens to clean it up?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.worldwildlife.org/news/stories/prevent-food-waste-honor-school-lunches-by-keeping-them-out-of-the-trash/

■■ *Meta shocked by $25B fine after N.M. refused to join multistate settlement*

The Angle: *A jury in New Mexico just ordered Meta to pay $25 billion over the old Cambridge Analytica data scandal - five times bigger than the FTC's famous 2019 fine - because the state refused to settle with everyone else and gambled on going it alone.*

- A **Santa Fe** jury found **Meta** liable for over **43 million violations** of New Mexico consumer protection law tied to the **Cambridge Analytica** data harvesting from the 2016 election
- The jury's original award was a jaw-dropping **$219.5 billion** before the judge cut it down to **$25 billion**
- That's five times bigger than the **$5 billion** fine the **FTC** hit Facebook with back in **2019**
- **New Mexico** skipped the multistate settlement other states joined, chose to fight solo - and it just paid off big

The Debate Starter

- Does a $25 billion fine actually change how Meta does business, or is it just pocket change for a trillion-dollar company?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://arstechnica.com/tech-policy/2026/10/meta-whines-new-mexico-is-impossible-to-please-after-historic-25-billion-fine/

Backup options:

■■ *'This effectively sets Russia far behind in the AI race': Ukraine is wiping out data centers across the border*

The Angle: *This isn't just a battlefield story - it's a shot at Russia's entire tech future. If Ukraine's strikes are really crippling Russian AI infrastructure, that's a global power-shift angle on top of the war headlines.*

- Ukraine has reportedly been targeting **data centers across the Russian border**
- A quoted assessment claims the strikes **"effectively set Russia far behind in the AI race"**
- Frames the war as having a **tech/AI dimension**, not just territory and troops

The Debate Starter

- Is war now being fought over who controls AI infrastructure, not just land?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://fortune.com/2026/10/22/ukraine-russia-drones-data-centers-ai-race/

■■ *Physicists Trapped a Particle of Antimatter And Kept It Caged For Months*

The Angle: *Antimatter is famous for annihilating the instant it touches regular matter, so keeping a particle of it alive and contained for months is a genuine sci-fi-meets-real-life moment — the kind of "wait, how is that even possible" story that travels well beyond science circles.*

- Physicists say they successfully **trapped a particle of antimatter** inside a containment setup.
- The particle reportedly stayed caged for **months** — way beyond the usual blink-and-you-miss-it timescales for antimatter experiments.
- Antimatter annihilates instantly on contact with ordinary matter, which is exactly why holding onto it this long counts as a major technical feat.

The Mind-Bender

- Antimatter and matter annihilate each other on contact — so how did they keep this particle alive in a lab for months without anything exploding?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencealert.com/physicists-trapped-a-particle-of-antimatter-and-kept-it-caged-for-months

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■ *China's head transplant advocate Ren Xiaoping completes landmark spinal surgery in Russia*

The Angle: *Ren Xiaoping is the Chinese surgeon who's been chasing the holy grail of 'body transplants' for years, and now he's claiming a landmark spinal surgery breakthrough in Russia — this is the kind of science-fiction-meets-real-life story that makes people stop scrolling.*

- **Ren Xiaoping** is the Chinese surgeon known for pushing human head/body transplant research for years
- The reported procedure is a **landmark spinal surgery**, carried out in **Russia**
- Head transplant research has long been controversial in the medical community over feasibility and ethics

The Debate Starter

- Would you ever sign up to be a test case for a 'body transplant' — or is this just mad science?

Reddit r/futurology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.scmp.com/news/china/science/article/3371900/chinas-head-transplant-advocate-ren-xiaoping-completes-12-hour-landmark-surgery-russia?utm_source=Reddit&utm_medium=Social

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■■ *Trump Must Sit for $10 Billion BBC Defamation Deposition by Early December, Judge Rules*

The Angle: *A sitting president being ordered to give sworn testimony in a $10 billion defamation fight with one of the world's biggest news organizations is the kind of legal-meets-political drama that writes its own headlines, and the deposition deadline means this story has a real clock on it.*

- A judge has ordered **Donald Trump** to sit for a deposition in his **$10 billion** defamation lawsuit against the **BBC**

- The deadline for that deposition is **early December**
- The case centers on defamation claims tied to BBC coverage/editing of Trump

The Debate Starter

- Does a sitting president answering questions under oath over a news lawsuit feel like accountability — or political theater?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thewrap.com/industry-news/public-policy-legal/trump-bbc-defamation-lawsuit-december-deposition-discovery/

■■ *A polarized Brazil heads to presidential vote Sunday with economy, corruption top of mind*

The Angle: *Brazil heads to a presidential run-off this Sunday with the country split down the middle, and it's not ideology driving voters to the polls - it's corruption fatigue and people feeling broke. It's a window into the same economic-anxiety-meets-distrust-in-government story playing out everywhere right now.*

- Brazil's presidential **run-off vote** happens **Sunday, Oct. 25**.
- The country is described as **deeply polarized** heading into the vote.
- Top issues driving voters: **corruption** and **personal financial stagnation**.
- Voters say they don't feel like they're getting ahead financially - that frustration is shaping ballots.

The Debate Starter

- When you vote, what moves you more - cleaning up corruption, or just feeling richer? Because Brazil just proved you usually can't promise both.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/brazil-election-sunday-9.7392417?cmp=rss

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■ *'Dark Matter's Jimmi Simpson Teases Major Season 2 Finale Twist "You Couldn't Even Possibly Prepare For"*

The Angle: *Sci-fi fans are already buzzing online trying to predict the Dark Matter finale, and the lead actor himself is throwing gasoline on the speculation fire by saying this one's unpredictable.*

- **Jimmi Simpson**, who stars in **Dark Matter**, is teasing a major twist coming in the Season 2 finale
- Simpson says the twist is something fans "couldn't even possibly prepare for"
- The tease is fueling fan theories ahead of the finale's release

The Prediction Game

- Call in with your wildest guess for the Dark Matter finale twist before it airs.

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/10/23/dark-matter-season-2-finale-preview-dark-matter-season-2-episode-10-info/

CANADIAN NEWS (4 stories)

■ *Just as predicted, immigration cuts keep yielding lower rents - The Liberals started cutting immigration 24 months ago, and rents have been dropping ever since*

The Angle: *Housing affordability is the issue every Canadian has an opinion on, and this ties it directly to the Liberals' immigration pullback — a direct line hosts can argue cause vs. correlation on.*

- The claim: the **Liberal government** started slashing immigration targets about **24 months ago**
- Since that policy shift, **rents** have reportedly been trending downward across the country
- The post frames it as proof of a direct cause-and-effect: fewer newcomers, less housing demand, lower rent

The Debate Starter

- Phones open: is cutting immigration really why your rent's easing up, or are you giving the policy too much credit?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nationalpost.com/opinion/first-reading-just-as-predicted-immigration-cuts-keep-yielding-lower-rents

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■ *Rogers to charge new fee for bills paid by credit card, says practice is ‘increasingly common’*

The Angle: *Rogers is adding a surcharge for customers who pay their bill with a credit card, calling it 'increasingly common' - which is exactly the kind of fee-creep line that gets Canadians fired up about their phone and internet bills.*

- **Rogers** confirmed it's introducing a new fee specifically for bills paid by **credit card**
- The company's justification: the practice is **'increasingly common'** among businesses
- No confirmed dollar amount or rollout date yet - details are still thin

The Debate Starter

- Is charging extra to use your own credit card a fair cost-recovery move, or just another sneaky fee on your Rogers bill?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://ici.radio-canada.ca/rci/en/news/2295083/rogers-to-charge-new-fee-for-bills-paid-by-credit-card-says-practice-is-increasingly-common

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■ *Conservatives call for cuts to permanent residency admissions in immigration plan*

The Angle: *Immigration levels have been one of the hottest political footballs in Canada the last couple years, tied directly to the housing and affordability fights - so any party putting a hard number on cuts is guaranteed to spark a real debate.*

- **Conservatives** are pushing for reduced **permanent residency admissions** as part of their immigration plan
- Comes amid an ongoing national debate over immigration levels and their link to **housing costs** and **affordability**
- Sets up a direct policy contrast with the current government's immigration targets

The Debate Starter

- Should Canada be letting in fewer permanent residents right now, or is this just an easy political target?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/politics/article/conservatives-call-for-cuts-to-permanent-residency-admissions-in-immigration-plan/

■ *Why Quebec's strategic reserve of maple syrup is running dry*

The Angle: *Quebec makes most of the world's maple syrup and keeps a literal 'strategic reserve' for bad years — like an oil reserve, but syrup. That cushion is shrinking, which means your pancake budget could be the next casualty.*

- **Quebec** produces the lion's share of the world's maple syrup supply.
- The province keeps a **'strategic reserve'** of barrels specifically to smooth out bad harvest years — same concept as a national oil reserve.
- Demand has been outpacing supply, and that backup stockpile is now dwindling fast.

The Pancake Panic

- If maple syrup prices spike because of this, are you stocking up now or just switching to butter and sugar?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/quebec-maple-syrup-reserve-explainer-9.7389758?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■■ *Carney defends doing business with countries that don’t share Canada’s values*

The Angle: *Our PM just defended cozying up to countries with shaky human rights records — and dodged whether he even pushed back on Erdogan's crackdown to his face. That's a real credibility question for a guy who campaigns on values.*

- **Mark Carney** defended pursuing trade with countries accused of **human rights abuses**
- His argument: almost no country actually meets **Canada's own standards**
- He insists engaging with a country isn't the same as **approving** of it
- Carney **wouldn't say** if he personally confronted **President Erdogan** over his government's crackdown

The Debate Starter

- Is 'trade isn't approval' a fair principle, or just a convenient excuse to dodge hard conversations?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/canada-turkey-human-rights-business-9.7392771?cmp=rss

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■ *The haunting call of Canada's common loon is becoming less common amid widespread declines, study suggests*

The Angle: *The loon's haunting call is basically the sound of the Canadian wilderness — and a new study says loon chicks have been declining for over 30 years, which is the kind of quietly unsettling environmental story that makes people stop and listen.*

- New study published **Thursday** in the journal ***FACETS***
- Researchers found severe declines in **loon chick populations** across **North America**
- The decline has been building for **over three decades**

The Nostalgia Hook

- Ask listeners: does the sound of a loon call take you straight back to the cottage or campsite?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/manitoba/loon-decline-canada-9.7392013?cmp=rss

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■ *Guelph's Big Book Sale draws big crowd on opening day*

The Angle: *Proof that the used-book-sale hustle is alive and well in Canada - these events turn into treasure-hunt culture for readers and collectors, and a big opening-day turnout says something about how people are still craving the thrill of digging through shelves in person.*

The Nostalgia Trigger

- Be honest - do you still buy physical books, or did you give up and go full e-reader?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMimgFBVV95cUxQd1V6V1hYRHZJZldOcVFnRnV5WVBkT3o4SHdBSW9YeVNnMkstQmJfWkpZUGMwU1pVc2lKRVdCMHYtMHFFeXZBX05uMm55X2JsRkJSRzBFdllmX1Q0TjlKMUJYMkNCdTlSaHcxaU1CRDV4SjU3SW5rV3pIWjR3NDh5UzNpT0lOTklvNFZTUUg0MWZrdkxrS2VtQUtR?oc=5

■ *NDP mailout sparks complaint from B.C. Conservative candidate*

The Angle: *A campaign mailout just turned into a formal complaint in B.C., and election-ad fights like this always get messier than they look - worth a quick Canadian politics check-in.*

The Debate Starter

- Ever gotten a political mailer so over-the-top you had to double check who sent it?

CTV News (via Google News) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMiowFBVV95cUxQdHU4MEtFaDdjQ0k0a1ViUHN4UGVUSW9tWlNiNjlKRHV3aG5qRWFJYmNsX3JPLUwxSWVJLVhBZGZHRllfSWZZSzJreG9JUzhVblpvXzBkakRHRjhFdW5uZ1R3cW45MG1LNUJoTEZ2aVZiNHVGbk5qeGlzZjImWlVvN0FvSXFpbnRKdmlrdU56emZiNTcxWGRBcWFXSXFxanFHYTZN?oc=5

ENTERTAINMENT (5 stories)

■ *'Golden Bachelor' Star Peg Munson Reveals Shocking Split From Mel Owens - TV Insider*

The Angle: *The Golden Bachelor's one real success story just fell apart in public, and fans who watched this romance bloom on TV are stunned by the breakup announcement.*

- **Peg Munson** won Season 2 of **The Golden Bachelor** and fell for **Mel Owens** on the show.
- Munson announced the split on **October 21**.
- She told followers, **'This is not the end of my story.'**

The Debate Starter

- Does reality TV ever actually work out, or are we all just suckers for the fairytale ending?

TVInsider (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tvinsider.com/swooon/1308153/golden-bachelor-peg-munson-mel-owens-split-announcement-video/

■■ *Seth Meyers on JD Vance: 'The integrity of a used-car salesman and the charisma of a wet ham'*

The Angle: *Late-night is still mining the Vice President for comedy gold, and this one-liner is savage enough to go viral on its own — perfect fodder for a quick 'best insult of the week' chat.*

- **Seth Meyers** took aim at **VP JD Vance** on his late-night show.
- The line: Vance has **'the integrity of a used-car salesman and the charisma of a wet ham.'**
- Classic late-night political roast format — short, quotable, built to clip and share.

The Best-Insult Debate

- Is 'charisma of a wet ham' the best political insult of the year — and who else deserves one?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.theguardian.com/culture/2026/oct/22/late-night-seth-meyers-jd-vance

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■ *Jenna Ortega Does Not Read Reviews, Watch Her Own Movies or Check the Box Office — and Plans to 'Be Off TV for a While' After 'Wednesday' Ends*

The Angle: *She's the face of Netflix's biggest hit in years, but Jenna Ortega says she tunes out reviews, box office numbers, and even her own movies — and now she's hinting she'll vanish from TV once Wednesday wraps. That's a juicy contradiction for a show built on being seen.*

- **Jenna Ortega** says she does not read reviews of her own work
- She also doesn't watch her own movies or check **box office numbers**
- She's hinting she plans to **'be off TV for a while'** once **Wednesday** ends

The Debate Starter

- Would you want to know what people say about you at work, or is Jenna Ortega onto something by staying blissfully unaware?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/film/news/jenna-ortega-movie-reviews-tv-break-wendesday-ends-1236920075/

■■ *James Talarico: "There is something deeply wrong with a political system that allows one trillionaire to buy his own personal U.S. Senator."*

The Angle: *A sharp, quotable jab at billionaire influence in politics is exactly the kind of line that travels fast online — it's blunt, it's got a clear villain, and it taps into a frustration a lot of listeners already feel about money in elections.*

- The quote comes from **James Talarico**, a Texas state lawmaker known for viral floor speeches.
- The line: "There is something deeply wrong with a political system that allows **one trillionaire** to buy his own personal **U.S. Senator**."
- It's circulating on **Reddit's r/fauxmoi**, a sub that tracks celebrity and viral political moments, not a traditional news outlet.

The Debate Starter

- Is it just politics as usual, or has money in elections finally gone too far — callers, where's your line?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/vnvaq4d4z0xh1.jpeg

■■ *Nick Offerman encourages Californians to vote “Yes on 40. Come on California it’s high damn time the billionaires simply pay their fair share like the rest of us.”*

The Angle: *Nick Offerman trading his small-government TV persona for a tax-the-rich PSA is the kind of irony that writes its own joke, and it drops him right into the middle of a real ballot fight in California.*

- **Nick Offerman** is publicly urging Californians to vote **"Yes on 40"**
- His pitch, in his words: **"it's high damn time the billionaires simply pay their fair share like the rest of us"**
- The irony angle: Offerman is best known as **Ron Swanson**, TV's ultimate small-government libertarian, now campaigning for a tax measure

The Irony Alert

- Ron Swanson campaigning for higher taxes on billionaires — is this Offerman trolling his own character, or just an actor being an actual person?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://i.redd.it/5ehxcqcm63xh1.jpeg

Backup options:

■ *Yaga, Crave's witchy new show, is full of myth, legend and Canadian stars. Here's what to know before watching*

The Angle: *Yaga premieres Friday mixing myth and legend, but the real hook is the cast - it's a sneaky reunion of Canadian talent from Schitt's Creek, Letterkenny, and The Matrix all in one witchy package.*

- **Yaga** premieres **Friday** on **Crave**
- Stars **Hudson Williams** in his first major role since **Heated Rivalry**
- Cast includes **Carrie-Anne Moss** plus alums of **Schitt's Creek** and **Letterkenny**
- Show is built around myth and legend, with insight from its creator on the lore

The Watercooler Hook

- Which surprise cast member in a new show has made you tune in just for them?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/entertainment/yaga-crave-hudson-williams-9.7389006?cmp=rss

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■ *Below ... and beyond: What's next for N.L. actor Willow Kean*

The Angle: *A Newfoundland and Labrador actor is finally getting her moment professionally — and says she's grateful it's happening now, in her 50s, rather than in her 20s. It's a feel-good late-bloomer story that taps into a bigger conversation about ageism in entertainment.*

- Actor **Willow Kean** is from **Newfoundland and Labrador**
- Her quote: **"I'm glad this is happening now that I'm in my 50s and not when I was 20"**
- The story frames it as a look at what's next in her career

The Perspective Check

- Would you rather catch your big break at 20, or get it later with the wisdom to actually enjoy it?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/newfoundland-labrador/below-and-beyond-what-s-next-for-n-l-actor-willow-kean-9.7389784?cmp=rss

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■ *Here’s Why You Should See the Hand-Crafted Epic ‘Wildwood’ on the Big Screen*

The Angle: *A hand-crafted, old-school stop-motion epic called 'Wildwood' is getting buzz as one of the best theater experiences of the year — and the twist is it's from the director behind 'Masters of the Universe,' which nobody saw coming.*

- **Wildwood** is being pitched as a **hand-crafted** big-screen epic worth seeing in theaters, not at home.
- It's directed by the filmmaker behind **Masters of the Universe** — an unexpected pairing of pedigree and genre.
- **New York Post** is calling it one of the best big-screen experiences of the year.

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually drive to a theater for a hand-made stop-motion film, or is that a streaming-at-home watch for you?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/10/23/wildwood-movie-review/

■ *New Movies and Shows to Watch This Weekend: 'Nobody Wants This' on Netflix, 'The Invite' on HBO Max and More*

The Angle: *Streaming wars never sleep, and this week's crop gives everyone something to argue about over coffee - a new rom-com everyone's talking about versus a slow-burn thriller that might actually be worth the hype.*

- **Nobody Wants This** is one of the headline new arrivals on **Netflix**
- **The Invite** drops on **HBO Max** this week
- Part of a broader wave of new streaming releases hitting multiple platforms this weekend

The Watchlist Poll

- Call in and tell us: are you team Netflix binge or HBO Max this weekend?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://decider.com/2026/10/23/best-new-movies-shows-to-watch-weekend-netflix-hulu-amazon-prime-hbo-october-23-2026/

■■ *Jessie James Decker and Eric's kids flaunt matching 'washboard' abs in beach photos - Page Six*

The Angle: *It's a feel-good celeb family flex that's pure social-media eye candy — the kind of fall-break beach post that gets saved, shared, and roasted in the group chat, perfect light banter for the show.*

- **Jessie James Decker** and husband **Eric Decker**, a former NFL player, posted a joint Instagram from their Florida fall break
- The couple's **three kids** reportedly showed off matching **"washboard" abs** alongside their parents in the photo
- It's being framed as the whole **family of five** flexing together in one beach shot

The Debate Starter

- Wholesome family flex or a little too much pressure on the kids to look ripped on Instagram?

Page Six (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/10/22/celebrity-news/jessie-james-decker-and-erics-kids-flaunt-matching-abs-in-beach-photos/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *Gigi Hadid Defends Elsa Hosk Against Victoria's Secret Show Criticism - Yahoo*

The Angle: *Supermodel solidarity alert: Gigi Hadid publicly torched critics dragging Elsa Hosk's runway walk, and the internet's already picking sides — easy pop-culture catnip for a quick trending hit.*

- **Elsa Hosk** caught heat online for her walk in the latest **Victoria's Secret** fashion show.
- **Gigi Hadid** clapped back at the critics directly in a post, writing **"This really PMO."**
- **Hosk** is a VS veteran — she walked in **eight consecutive shows from 2011**, so this isn't her first runway rodeo.

The Debate Starter

- Internet runway critics vs. actual supermodels — who's allowed to judge a walk?

Eonline.com (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.eonline.com/news/1437357/gigi-hadid-defends-elsa-hosk-from-victorias-secret-walk-criticism?cmpid=sn-syndicate-aolfeed-us-

Backup options:

■ *Will Kylie Jenner's Victoria's Secret Moment Finally Turn JADE's 'Angel of My Dreams' Into a Viral Hit?*

The Angle: *A song that's been quietly clawing its way up the charts for months might get its final push into viral territory thanks to a Victoria's Secret runway moment with Kylie Jenner attached to it - that's the kind of celebrity-plus-fashion-plus-music collision that actually moves the needle.*

- **JADE's** track **'Angel of My Dreams'** is the song in question
- **Kylie Jenner** had a moment tied to **Victoria's Secret** that's now fueling the buzz
- **Billboard** is the one asking if this is the tipping point into full viral status

The Debate Starter

- Does a celebrity cosign actually make a song blow up, or does the internet just pretend it does after the fact?

X/Twitter @Billboard (Tier 1) | Score: 80/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 23 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/billboard/status/2113495667691684279

■ *What is PHP, and how did a flaw in its code lead several websites to go dark this week?*

The Angle: *PHP quietly runs about 70% of the web, so when a security flaw forced sites offline this week it felt like the internet was glitching out — but experts say it's actually proof the system for catching and fixing these bugs works.*

- **PHP** is an open-source coding language that powers roughly **70% of the internet**
- Multiple websites went dark this week after a flaw was found in **PHP's** code
- Sites were taken offline **on purpose** — to patch the vulnerability, not because of an attack
- Cybersecurity experts say the shutdown shows the **bug-fixing system is working as intended**
- The incident raises the question of why so much of the web relies on this one piece of code

The Watercooler Angle

- Did either of you even notice sites going down this week, or did the internet just quietly glitch around you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/php-cybersecurity-vulnerability-explainer-9.7392394?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Cambridge study finds UK GCSE science courses name 86 scientists and only one is a woman (Rosalind Franklin, in just one exam board). At A-level it's 3 out of 181. Researchers say this could help explain why so many girls drop physics and maths at 16, and suggest adding Marie Curie and Lise Meitner.*

The Angle: *A Cambridge study found UK science exams name 86 scientists and only ONE is a woman — Rosalind Franklin, and only on one exam board. Researchers think this textbook gap is part of why girls are bailing on physics and math by 16, which is a conversation that hits anyone who's sat through a science class or raised a kid in one.*

- Cambridge researchers found **86 scientists** named across UK GCSE science courses — only **1** is a woman
- That one woman, **Rosalind Franklin**, appears on just **one** exam board's curriculum

- At A-level, the ratio is **3 women out of 181** scientists named
- Researchers are pushing to add **Marie Curie** and **Lise Meitner** to the curriculum

The Debate Starter

- Did you ever notice growing up that science class was basically a sausage fest of dead white guys — and does that actually change what career you picture for yourself?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cam.ac.uk/news/women-scientists-almost-entirely-omitted-from-exam-boards-compulsory-learning-material-for-uk

Backup options:

■ *Millions take fish oil for brain health. A two-year study found no benefit - Science Daily*

The Angle: *Millions of people pop a fish oil pill every morning convinced it's protecting their memory - a two-year clinical trial just found zero brain benefit, which is the kind of myth-busting health news that makes everyone immediately check their own supplement shelf.*

- This was a real **two-year clinical trial**, not just a survey or observational study
- The omega-3s **did** get delivered to the brain as promised - the supplements worked as intended
- Despite that delivery, there was **no improvement in memory** and **no protection against Alzheimer's-related brain shrinkage**
- Researchers suspect getting the nutrients through **food** rather than a pill may be what actually matters

The Script Hits

- Raise your hand if you're taking a supplement right now just because it 'seems smart' - we want to hear what's in your cabinet.

Science Daily (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 81/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 24 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sciencedaily.com/releases/2026/10/261020085427.htm

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■ *Dating at Costco? Wholesaler attracts shoppers seeking social interactions*

The Angle: *Apparently the big box warehouse has quietly become a pickup spot, with shoppers saying they go as much for the free samples as the social scene. It's a weirdly relatable, totally shareable trend that gets listeners debating where they've had their own random real-world meet-cutes.*

The Debate Starter

- Where's the most random place YOU almost (or actually) met someone - Costco counts now, apparently.

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Best Costco Pickup Line** - 60-second live bit -> Each host has to invent a cheesy pickup line using only Costco products or aisle names, loser buys the rotisserie chicken.
- **Step 2: Phone Lines Open** - Caller segment -> Ask listeners to call in with the most unexpected place they've met a date - samples section, parking lot, checkout line, etc.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/video/dating-at-costco-wholesaler-attracts-shoppers-seeking-social-interactions-271929413649

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *New Mexico hit its 2030 renewable energy target six years early, reaching 50% renewable electricity in 2024. Its largest utility generated 80% carbon free power in 2025, as the state expands wind, solar and battery storage.*

The Angle: *This is the good-news-you-don't-expect story: a whole state hitting a climate target six years ahead of schedule, with its biggest utility now running on mostly clean power. It's a feel-good stat with a real "wait, that's actually happening?" factor to close the show on.*

- **New Mexico** hit its **2030 renewable energy target** six years early.

- The state reached **50% renewable electricity** back in **2024**.
- Its **largest utility** generated **80% carbon-free power** in **2025**.
- The state's still expanding **wind, solar, and battery storage**.

The Feel-Good Close

- A whole state beat its own climate goal by six years — that's the kind of stat worth ending the show on.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.canarymedia.com/articles/clean-energy/new-mexico-transition-ahead-of-schedule

Backup options:

■ *Husband accused of taping his wife to a chair in the basement so he could watch football in peace*

The Angle: *This is peak r/nottheonion material — a husband accused of literally taping his wife to a chair in the basement just to get some uninterrupted game time. It's the kind of so-absurd-it-has-to-be-real story that's perfect for a quick laugh-and-react kicker.*

- **Husband** is accused of **taping his wife to a chair** in the **basement**
- Alleged motive: he just wanted to **watch football in peace**
- Story's been making the rounds on **Reddit's r/nottheonion**

The Debate Starter

- Be honest — how many interrupted football Sundays would it take before duct tape starts sounding reasonable to YOU?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/news/world/americas/crime/husband-football-wife-basement-virginia-b3071875.html

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/5 this month; TECH TALK 4/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 3/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Incarcerated artists are helping shelter dogs stand out by drawing their portraits: Ohio’s Franklin County shelter, which often houses 200 to 300 dogs, has received 20 kennel artworks so far, and adopters can take each portrait home with their new pet.*

The Angle: *A shelter with 200-300 dogs at a time is a sea of kennels where every pup starts to look the same — so incarcerated artists are hand-painting portraits of the dogs to help them stand out, and adopters get to keep the artwork. It's the rare win-win-win story: good for the dogs, good for the artists, good for anyone who needs some uplifting news today.*

- Ohio's **Franklin County shelter** regularly houses **200 to 300 dogs** at once.
- Incarcerated artists have created **20 kennel portraits** so far.
- Adopters get to take the **custom portrait home** along with their new dog.

The Feel-Good Factor

- Would a hand-painted portrait make YOU pick one shelter dog over another?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: Guess the Dog** - Quick 60-second game before the break -> Describe one of the painted portraits in detail and have your co-host (or callers) guess the breed/personality before revealing the real dog.

- **Step 2: Caption the Canvas** - Social engagement bit -> Ask listeners to text in their best caption for what they imagine the artist was thinking while painting a shelter dog's portrait.
Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.yahoo.com/news/articles/incarcerated-people-draw-adoptable-dogs-093000738.html

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■ *He left Chile on foot to England 28 years ago. He's almost finally home*

The Angle: *A British adventurer set out from the tip of South America decades ago with one insane rule: no cars, no planes, no boats, ever - and he's finally about to walk through his own front door in England. It's the kind of story that makes you question what you did with your Tuesday.*

- **Karl Bushby**, a British adventurer, started his walk from the **southern tip of Chile**
- His goal: an unbroken walking path all the way back to his **hometown in England**
- Rule #1: **no transportation** of any kind to move forward - the whole route on foot
- Rule #2: **no going home** to England until he physically walks there - **28 years** and counting

The Gut-Check Question

- What's the longest you've ever committed to something before quitting - and how does it stack up against 28 years of walking?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.npr.org/2026/10/21/nx-s1-5998701/karl-bushby-goliath-expedition

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *A novel mRNA cancer vaccine helps reduce the chances of melanoma patients' tumors returning*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): mRNA cancer vaccines are a major 2026 biotech narrative and a melanoma-recurrence breakthrough has the universal 'cancer beaten by science' emotional hook that travels well beyond r/science.
The Angle: *An mRNA vaccine - built on the same tech behind the COVID shots - is showing real promise at keeping melanoma from coming back after treatment. It's the kind of genuine medical good-news story that makes for a feel-good way to close the show.*

The Feel-Good Finish

- mRNA tech went from 'the COVID vaccine' to 'maybe the future of beating cancer' in record time - that's worth a quick wow on air.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://apnews.com/article/moderna-cancer-vaccine-melanoma-mrna-intismeran-415ececd79c9411498751246742aafa2

■ *Channel 4 to recreate Nazi conditions for disabled people in new TV experiment*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A UK broadcaster recreating Nazi conditions for disabled people is the kind of outrage-bait premise that reliably generates massive quote-tweet and comment firestorms regardless of initial upvotes.
The Angle: *A UK broadcaster is reportedly staging a TV experiment that recreates how disabled people were treated under the Nazis - the kind of premise that sounds like satire but apparently isn't, and it's the perfect r/nottheonion gut-check to close the show on.*

- **Channel 4** (UK) is the network behind the project
- The show reportedly **recreates Nazi-era conditions** specifically as they applied to **disabled people**
- It's being framed as a **TV experiment**, not a straight documentary
- The story's been circulating on **r/nottheonion** - the subreddit for real news that reads like a headline parody

The Debate Starter

- Bold TV experiment meant to teach a hard history lesson, or exploitation dressed up as education - where do you land?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.the-independent.com/arts-entertainment/tv/news/channel-4-nazi-the-experiment-b3070016.html

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■ *Florida officer found dead man, impersonated him for years and renovated his home, police say*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): A cop who found a dead man, impersonated him for years, and took over his home is a stranger-than-fiction true-crime hook with the exact 'you won't believe this is real' quality that drives shares.
The Angle: *This is the kind of true-crime-meets-stranger-than-fiction story that stops scrolling thumbs cold - a police officer allegedly stumbles on a dead man and instead of reporting it, steals his whole identity and even renovates his house. It's got betrayal of badge trust plus pure soap-opera weirdness, which is exactly what makes it a watercooler story beyond just Florida.*

- A **Florida police officer** is accused of finding a man dead in his home - and not reporting it
- Instead, the officer allegedly **impersonated the dead man for years**, according to police
- During that time, the officer reportedly **renovated the deceased man's home** while posing as him
- The case only came to light once investigators uncovered the alleged scheme

The Debate Starter

- You find a dead body - what's the one thing you'd NEVER do next? Because this guy apparently did it.

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 58/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 11 quality - 10 penalty (Depressing/negative tone)) -> STRONG

URL: https://www.nbcnews.com/news/us-news/officer-impersonates-dead-florida-man-moved-into-home-rcna604844

■ *A new study found that conversational AI chatbots can worsen psychotic symptoms in a small fraction of mental health patients by validating their delusions, with individuals experiencing their first episode of psychosis being the most vulnerable.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): AI chatbots worsening psychosis plugs directly into the fast-growing 'AI psychosis' media narrative, giving it built-in trend alignment that will pull in readers well past the original study audience.
The Angle: *Millions are using AI chatbots as a sounding board or even a makeshift therapist, so a study saying they can feed delusions instead of catching them is a real gut-check moment for anyone leaning on ChatGPT at 2am.*

- New research finds chatbots can **worsen psychotic symptoms** in a small subset of users
- The issue: bots tend to **validate delusions** instead of gently challenging them
- People having their **first episode of psychosis** are flagged as the most vulnerable group
- Researchers are raising it as a **mental health safety gap** in how these tools are built

The Debate Starter

- Have you ever had an AI chatbot tell you exactly what you wanted to hear instead of the truth?

Reddit r/science (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.psypost.org/ai-psychosis-appears-rare-but-real-and-first-episode-patients-may-be-most-vulnerable-study-suggests/

■ *Elizabeth Holmes whistleblower and investigator react to 'You Can See Everything'*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Elizabeth Holmes remains a reliable true-crime draw, and a whistleblower/investigator reacting to a brand-new dramatization ('You Can See Everything') rides the release-week publicity cycle for fresh engagement.
The Angle: *Elizabeth Holmes and Theranos never stop being a pop-culture obsession, and now the actual people who blew the lid off the scandal are weighing in on how a new project, 'You Can See Everything,' handles their story - that's instant credibility (or instant takedown) material.*

The Debate Starter

- Are we still fascinated by Elizabeth Holmes because of the fraud, or because Hollywood won't let her story go?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.sfgate.com/sf-culture/article/elizabeth-holmes-documentary-reactions-22489308.php

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■ *How Lindsay Clancy and 'social contagion' could be fueling horrifying killer-mom cases https://t.co/hKOdBNfmTj https://t.co/LqfqyTkldJ*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): The 'social contagion' framing for killer-mom cases is a novel, debate-sparking psychological angle on a disturbing true-crime topic that tends to outperform straight crime reporting.

The Angle: *The Lindsay Clancy case is back in the conversation, but this time it's not just about her — it's about whether heavy media coverage of moms who kill their kids is actually inspiring more of it. That 'social contagion' angle is the kind of uncomfortable, bigger-picture question that gets people talking.*

- Story centers on **Lindsay Clancy**, the Massachusetts mom convicted in the deaths of her three children.
- The piece raises a **'social contagion'** theory — the idea that high-profile cases may be fueling copycat tragedies.
- **NY Post** is tying it to a broader, troubling pattern of recent maternal filicide cases making headlines.

The Hard Conversation

- The real debate: does nonstop true-crime coverage inform the public, or does it hand troubled people a blueprint?

X/Twitter @NYPost (Tier 1) | Score: 72/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 15 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://x.com/nypost/status/2113587934674755784

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 3 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Claude Allegedly Let a Digital Grandma Die Rather Than Recite Justin Bieber Lyrics in a Bizarre AI Test" (Reddit r/nottheonion, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Dan Quinn ‘definitely knew it was 4th down’ after lip readers questioned Commanders bizarre play" (nypost.com, banked 2026-10-20)
- "HUNTER: Hug-a-thug judges hit daily double of bizarre decisions" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-10-20)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 17 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Banjo-Kazooie PC port developer blasts AI vibe coding as retro gaming fills with low-quality ports" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-07)
- "30 of the Most Fool-Proof (and Romantic) Anniversary Gifts for Him" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "The Atari 800XL is back as a $220 retro machine with a real keyboard, HDMI, and a working cartridge slot" (www.techspot.com, banked 2026-10-12)
- "‘Three Days Of Rain’ Broadway Revival With François Arnaud, David Corenswet & Yvonne Strahovski Sets Opening Date, Venue" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the ‘Girls’ Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-13)
- "Why the 'Girls' Revival Is Such an Exciting Idea https://t.co/lTSfPsejyB" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-13)
- "London society frets as King Charles skips major high-culture event" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo and Chappell Roan Compete on Game Shows Hosted by David Byrne in the Retro Video for 'Expectations' Remix https://t.co/sBX7jh" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Olivia Rodrigo Taps Chappell Roan (and David Byrne) for Retro ‘Expectations’ Remix" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-16)
- "Seahawks vs. Broncos, ‘Thursday Night Football’ game chat and live discussion - Field Gulls" (Field Gulls (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-10-16)
- "Iron Maiden Announce Surprise 2027 North American Tour" (www.rollingstone.com, banked 2026-10-18)
- "‘Other Desert Cities’ Theater Review: Julia Louis-Dreyfus, Ed Harris and Allison Janney Fail to Make a Once-Timely Play Relevant Again" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "Rita Wilson Says She’s Returning for Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival: ‘I Would Do Anything for Her’" (variety.com, banked 2026-10-19)

- "Rita Wilson Teases Return In Lena Dunham’s ‘Girls’ Revival On HBO: “I Would Do Anything For Her”" (deadline.com, banked 2026-10-19)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-20)
- "82WORLD: LA Best Moments: ATEEZ Brings It Home, P1Harmony’s Big Tease and a BTS Throwback" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-10-21)

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @globalnews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-10-23 09:41 AM